

» IN MEMORIAM  
FRANZ BECKENBAUER

# Football world loses its emperor

The legendary German footballer left an indelible mark on the sport with his extraordinary contributions as a player, manager, and administrator.

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**F**ranz Beckenbauer, who was hailed as one of the game's greatest exponents, bid his fans and idolaters the final goodbye at the age of 78 on Sunday, January 7.

A statement from the Beckenbauer family conveyed the news that one of the biggest icons of world football had passed away in his sleep in the German town of Salzburg.

Famously known by the sobriquet 'Der Kaiser', which he earned for his charisma and dominance on the field in his favourite club Bayern Munich, Beckenbauer made a permanent place among immortal heroes in the sport with extraordinary performances for his country and the clubs he represented. This is reflected in his achievements, which have very few equivalents in the sport.

The fact that he is one of the only three men to have won the World Cup both as a player and manager speaks of the immense influence he had in enhancing the glory of the 'Beautiful Game'. The other two names in this elite club are Brazil's Mario Zagao and Frenchman Didier Deschamps.

"As a player, he brought a sense of effortlessness, elegance, and magic to the pitch. Franz Beckenbauer brought the glamour. Even after his playing career, he left an indelible mark on FC Bayern and football, and his legacy cannot be measured in titles," Bayern Munich president Herbert Hainer's tribute aptly sums

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**Technical genius:** Beckenbauer's class reflected in his wonderful understanding of the game and his great skills as a player. He could elegantly control the ball and initiate effective attacks while finding the chinks in the opposition's game plan.

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